

Standard Work And SOPs

One agreed, documented, best known way to do a task, followed by all until a better way is adopted.

Why It Matters

When five people each do a task their own way, you get five levels of quality, five speeds, and five ways to go wrong. When a problem appears there is no baseline to compare against, and any improvement lives only in one person's head. Variation in method creates uncontrolled variation in results.

Three Powers

Standard work locks in improvement so it cannot erode. It makes training and handoffs easy, because a new person can read the standard and do the task correctly on day one. And it creates the foundation for the next improvement, because you can only improve a stable, known baseline.

Where AI Fits

The everyday vehicle is the SOP, a clear step by step guide so anyone gets the same good result. Writing them used to be tedious, but you can describe your process in rough spoken language and AI drafts a clean, professional SOP in minutes. It cannot know if a step is accurate or a safety note is missing, so the human reviews and owns it.

Remember this

Standard work is not the enemy of improvement, it is the launch pad for it.